

Ten things we sell, and who else sells them

Twenty three products were priced against the ten lines 4orm Finance charges for. Each line is explained before it is compared, so a reader meeting this market for the first time can follow the argument without any background in financial regulation. The finding is the same on every line: no vendor anywhere sells software built for Canadian retail payments safeguarding.

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PRODUCTS PRICED	BUILT FOR THE CANADIAN DUTY	THAT PROVE A RECORD IS UNALTERED	THAT COMPARE HELD AGAINST OWED DAILY	WITH A CANADIAN PRESENCE, NONE ON THIS

1 Start here

Everything in this document rests on one obligation, and the obligation is simpler than the language around it. If a Canadian business holds money that belongs to its customers, it now has to write down every day how much of that money it is holding and who it belongs to, keep that record, and produce it when an outside examiner asks. The six terms below are the whole vocabulary needed to read the rest of this document.

End user funds	Money a business is holding that belongs to somebody else. A customer's balance sitting with a payment company before it is paid out. A tenant's deposit held by a property manager. It never belonged to the business and the business cannot spend it.
Safeguarding	Keeping that money separate from the company's own, in an account that survives the company failing, so customers are paid back even when the business is not.
The ledger	The daily list. Who is owed what, at the close of every single day. This is the record the regulation names, and it is the thing most firms are not keeping.
Reconciliation	Comparing two numbers that should agree: what the bank says is in the account, against what the ledger says customers are owed. When they do not agree the difference is a shortfall, and it has to be found and fixed.
The independent review	An outside examination of whether a business is doing all of the above properly, carried out by somebody who had no part in setting it up. Required at least once every three years.
Evidence	What the examiner is actually shown. Not a description of the process, but the records themselves, for the days they ask about.

2 What the rules require, and what they do not

The rules are the Retail Payment Activities Regulations, published as SOR/2023-229. Two sections carry everything in this document. Section 15 requires the safeguarding framework to keep a ledger naming each end user whose funds are held. It must also show the amount held for each of them at the end of each day. Section 17 requires an independent review of compliance at least once every three years, carried out by somebody who had no role in establishing, implementing or maintaining the framework.

Two things the regulation does not say, which govern how every claim here is worded

It names no first date for the review, and it imposes no period the review must cover. Three years is the longest gap allowed between reviews, not a window the reviewer looks back over. Any first date is arithmetic from 8 September 2025 and appears here as arithmetic. Separately there are two different reviews: section 10 covers risk management and binds only a provider that has an internal or external auditor, and section 17 covers safeguarding and binds every provider holding end user funds.

3 The four kinds of product, and why the kind decides the comparison

A buyer comparing prices will put a screening subscription next to an evidence system and ask why one costs twenty times the other. The answer is that they are not the same kind of thing, so every product in this document is classed before it is priced.

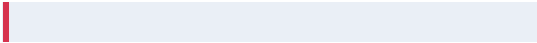
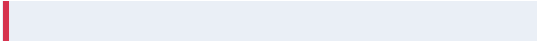
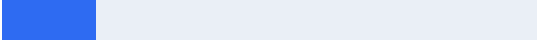
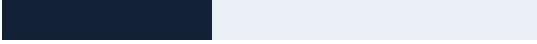
A point tool	Answers one narrow question and keeps no record. A sanctions screen says whether a name is on a list. An identity check says whether a person is who they claim. Priced from \$1,665 a year, and the cheapest figure a buyer will reach for.
An evidence platform	Watches a company's systems, collects the proof an auditor will ask for, and files it. Workiva, AuditBoard, Vanta, Drata and eight others. Real products with real customers. None connects to a bank account or a customer ledger, so none can see money.
A reconciliation engine	Compares two sets of numbers and reports what does not agree. Eight were priced. Four compute a daily customer money position, and all four are built for the British rules.
An adviser	A person who does the work by hand. This is what the Canadian market buys today. Every Canadian firm checked prices by scoping call, and none publishes a rate for a review, a remediation or an examination response.

4 The twenty three products, by kind

Each was read on its own published material on 16 and 17 August 2026. A product is recorded as not covering a regime when that regime is absent from its own published framework list, which is a statement about what it sells today rather than about what it could build.

Kind of product	What was priced	Count
Reconciliation engine	AutoRek, Kani Payments, Guardexia, Equali, Aurum Solutions, Duco, Gresham Technologies, ReconArt	8
Evidence platform	Workiva, AuditBoard, Vanta, Drata, Secureframe, LogicGate, Diligent, Sprinto, Hyperproof, MetricStream, Riskconnect, OneTrust	12
Retention and archive	Global Relay, Smarsh, Mimecast, Proofpoint, Microsoft Purview, Iron Mountain	6
Anti money laundering and identity	Nasdaq Verafin, Unit21, Alessa, ComplyAdvantage, Sumsb, Napier AI, Flinks, Trulioo	8
Ledger infrastructure	Modern Treasury, Fragment	2
Control testing	Cable, now inside Synctera	1
Built for the Canadian safeguarding duty	None of them	0

Legend. The counts total more than twenty three because several products were priced against more than one of our lines. Kind is assigned on what a product does rather than on how it is marketed.

Carry the Canadian rule		0 of 23
Prove a record is unaltered		0 of 23
Reconstruct history		0 of 23
Compare held against owed		4 all British
Publish any price at all		9 of 23

Bars start at zero and run to twenty three, the full set. The nine publishing a price of any kind are Guardexia, Sumsb, ComplyAdvantage, Secureframe, ReconArt, Microsoft, Iron Mountain, Proofpoint and Equali, and Equali publishes only its unregulated tiers. The other fourteen quote on request, which is why signed contract data is used wherever it exists.

5 Line A, the subscription

Every day the system reads what the bank says is in the safeguarding account and what the company's own books say each customer is owed. It compares the two, records the answer, and seals it so it can be shown later to have gone unchanged. That sealed daily record is the subscription, and at \$52,279,213 in 2031 it is the largest line in the plan.

What we charge \$29,450 a year for a small regulated firm, \$83,250 mid market, \$219,500 enterprise, \$687,000 command and institution, and \$130,000 partner and white label, from 1 January 2028.

What a firm actually pays The card rises once, on 1 January 2028, and a firm keeps the price it signed at for as long as it stays. A small firm signing in 2027 locks \$32,837 for life, one signing in 2028 locks \$36,813, and nobody is ever repriced.

Who else sells anything comparable	Built for	Their price	In Canadian dollars
AutoRek, Glasgow	British client asset rules	not published	n/a
Kani Payments, Newcastle	British safeguarding and card scheme reporting	from US\$2,000 a month	\$33,300
Guardexia, London	British safeguarding and capital adequacy	GBP 1,500 to 3,500 a month	\$33,822 to \$78,918
Equali, London	British safeguarding, quoted case by case	not published	n/a
Vanta	Security certificates, 23 frameworks, none Canadian	US\$20,000 median observed	\$27,750
Drata	Security certificates, 33 frameworks, none Canadian	US\$24,868 observed median	\$34,504
4orm Finance small tier, locked from 2028	SOR/2023-229 sections 15 and 17	US\$26,532	\$36,813

Legend. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source for our figures: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

Four products compute a daily held against owed position, and all four are British

AutoRek, Kani, Guardexia and Equali each do the daily calculation against the British client asset rules. AutoRek is the only one of the twenty three naming Canada at all, in a single coverage line with no mention of the Retail Payment Activities Act, SOR/2023-229 or the Bank of Canada anywhere on its site. The evidence platforms, far larger, cannot do the calculation at any price, because none connects to a bank account or a ledger.

6 Line B, retention and archive

A daily record is worth nothing if it has gone by the time somebody asks about it. This line keeps every sealed daily record for seven years, indexed so a single day can be produced in seconds rather than restored from a backup. It carries \$3,136,753 in 2031, and it survives the subscription being switched off, because a firm that stops buying the daily record still owes the retention on what it already has.

Who else sells retention	What it actually holds	Their price	In Canadian dollars
Global Relay, Vancouver	Email, chat, voice, mobile. No financial records	not published	n/a
Smarsh	Email, chat, voice, social. No financial records	not published	n/a
Mimecast	Email only	not published	n/a
Proofpoint Essentials, Professional	Email, with archiving in the top tier	US\$5.33 a user a month	\$88.75 a user a year
Microsoft Purview Suite	Any document in Microsoft 365, with no financial data model	\$16.30 a user a month	\$195.60 a user a year
Iron Mountain, federal schedule	Cardboard boxes of paper	US\$0.347 a cubic foot a month	\$5.78 a cubic foot a year
4orm Finance	The sealed daily safeguarding record, indexed to the day	a share of the card	scales with the tier

Legend. Proofpoint figures are its published manufacturer's suggested price list of October 2021. Microsoft Purview is the published Canadian storefront price on an annual commitment. Iron Mountain is the published United States federal supply schedule effective 15 May 2023. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source for our figures: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

The archiving industry is large, mature, and holds the wrong thing

Global Relay is Canadian, based in Vancouver, and states more than 20,000 customers. Every data source it publishes is a communications channel. Smarsh and Mimecast are the same. Microsoft Purview will retain a reconciliation workbook because it retains any file, but it has no financial data model, so a regulator's request for a specific day resolves to a document search rather than to a record. Iron Mountain retains the paper. No product in this category indexes a reconciliation, a shortfall, or its resolution.

7 Line C, evidence reconstruction

The duty to keep a daily customer by customer ledger began on 8 September 2025. Most firms have not been keeping it, which means that when a reviewer arrives there is nothing to review. This line goes back through bank statements, processor files and internal records and rebuilds the daily position for every day a firm has been holding funds. It carries \$2,466,000 in 2028 and falls to \$1,941,306 by 2031, because it is designed to expire.

What we charge	\$90,000 for command and enterprise, \$45,000 mid market and partner, \$15,000 small, on a discount ladder starting at forty per cent off while the first customers are being won and narrowing as the regime matures.
Who else sells it	Nobody sells it as a product. None of the twenty three offers historical reconstruction of a safeguarding position, and every one begins monitoring on the day it is connected.
What the market buys instead	A consultancy engagement. Outlier Solutions states the work can be done on a fixed fee basis and publishes no figure. ComplyFactor promises a written quote inside forty eight hours and no rate. Renno and Company publishes a thirty day engagement and no rate.
The only published Canadian figures	An adviser's own stated estimates rather than quoted fees: a compliance programme build from US\$15,000, which converts to \$20,813, and a first year budget from US\$20,000, which converts to \$27,750. Neither is reconstruction of a historical ledger.
Why the price holds	Rebuilding a ledger that was never kept is a larger piece of work than a readiness assessment, and it is priced at the top of the observed readiness band rather than above it. Delivery costs fifty five per cent of the fee, the highest on any line in the plan.

The only competitor on this line is a spreadsheet and a contractor

There is no software answer to a ledger that was never written. The work is done by people reading statements, and the Canadian firms that do it will not publish what they charge. That is an opening and a warning at once: an opening because nobody has productised it, and a warning because a buyer has no reference price and will treat any number as negotiable.

The line is built to shrink. The workbook holds a check that fails if this line is ever larger in 2031 than in 2028. A reconstruction line that grows would mean the discount ladder or the take up rate is wrong, because every year the regime runs, the gap a new customer has to fill gets shorter.

8 Line D, the review and annual report packs

Three separate filings, each owed by a date rather than on request. Every registered provider owes the Bank of Canada an annual report by 31 March covering the previous calendar year. Every provider holding customer funds owes an independent review of its safeguarding compliance at least once every three years. Most also carry anti money laundering obligations to FINTRAC, the Financial Transactions and Reports Analysis Centre of Canada. This line assembles the evidence pack for each, and carries \$10,346,903 in 2031.

What a Canadian firm can buy today	From whom	Published price
An independent review	Outlier Solutions, ComplyFactor, Renno and Company	none published by any of them
An anti money laundering programme build	AML Incubator, Substance Law, and packagers	packagers only, from EUR 9,800
Preparation of the Bank of Canada annual report	nobody found selling it as a product	none published
The registration application itself	Bank of Canada, statutory fee	\$2,500 flat
A compliance officer to own the filings	the employment market	\$83,000 to \$114,000 a year
4orm Finance annual report pack, small tier	productised and priced on the card	\$3,000 a year

Legend. Compliance officer pay is the published Canadian median of \$44.10 an hour for a regulatory compliance officer, at mid level. The registration fee is the published Bank of Canada figure, in force since 1 November 2024 and adjusted each year by the consumer price index. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source for our figures: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

The annual report is the strongest line in the plan and the least contested

It is the only obligation in the regime carrying a fixed statutory date, 31 March, in section 18 of the regulations. Every registered provider owes it every year without exception. Nobody in Canada sells a fixed price pack against it. A firm's alternative is an adviser who will not quote until they have scoped, or a compliance officer whose salary is more than twenty seven times the price of the pack.

9 Line E, the second regulator

A firm holding customer money often owes the same proof to more than one authority. A property management brokerage holds deposits under a provincial real estate act. A law firm holds retainers under a law society rule. The daily record is the same record, so this line charges to configure it against a second rule set rather than to rebuild it, and carries \$13,766,769 in 2031.

Who else sells it	Nobody. No vendor in the research offers a second jurisdiction or second regulator configuration on a safeguarding record. The widest claim found anywhere is the United Kingdom and Europe in one tenancy.
What this depends on	The share of customers carrying a second regulated duty. It is the most sensitive input in the model, no published Canadian figure exists for it, and the workbook carries a check that flags the line if it passes fifteen per cent of revenue.
How it should be quoted	Switched off, until a second regulator customer signs. The workbook carries a switch for exactly that, and turning it off takes 2031 revenue to \$91,510,177 without breaking any check in the model.

10 Line F, retrieval and attach meters

Seven counted things, each with its own fee. An extra legal entity beyond the first. Each safeguarding account at each custodian. A band of retrieval volume. Each source system feeding the ledger. A committed twenty four hour production window, or a seventy two hour one. And the sealed page a reviewer is sent to instead of a folder of exports. Together \$17,035,003 in 2031.

The nearest thing anyone sells	What is metered	Published price
Microsoft Purview, pay as you go	Retrieval per gigabyte per day, audit per thousand records	meters named, rates not published
Modern Treasury	Per payment rail, plus a platform fee, on one minimum commitment	no figures published
Iron Mountain	Retrieval per cubic foot, rush retrieval per file	US\$2.21 and US\$5.72
Cable, now inside Synctera	Auditor read only access to control test results	not published
4orm Finance	Seven named meters, each with its own fee and take up	on the rate card

Legend. Cable appears because auditor read only access is the closest published analogue to a citable evidence page, although it tests controls rather than holding a funds position. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source for our figures: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

11 The services

Four lines, none of them recurring, and all of them falling as a share of revenue as the subscription grows. Together \$6,771,000 in 2031 against total revenue of \$105,276,946, which is six and a half per cent.

What we sell	What it is	2031	What a Canadian firm can buy instead
Implementation	Connecting the banks, the processors and the ledger, then proving the first daily record	\$4,156,000	An integration contractor. No published rate found.
Readiness programme design	Building the framework before an examination rather than after one	\$875,000	An adviser. Programme build from US\$15,000 on one adviser's own estimate.
Remediation	Fixing what a regulator or reviewer found, against a deadline	\$540,000	An adviser. No firm in Canada publishes a price.
Examination response	A regulator, reviewer or bank asks, and the answer is assembled	\$1,200,000	An adviser, again unpriced.
TOTAL SERVICES	None of it recurring	\$6,771,000	Quote on scoping, every time

Legend. Foreign figures converted at the Bank of Canada daily rates of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar and 1.8790 for the pound sterling. Our figure is the price a firm locks signing from 1 January 2028 and keeps for as long as it stays. Source for our figures: 4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026, base case.

The whole Canadian services market prices by scoping call, and that is the opening

MNP, Deloitte Canada, KPMG Canada and every boutique checked publish no hourly rate, no per diem and no fixed fee for a review, a remediation or an examination response. A buyer cannot compare two quotes without commissioning both.

Two of the six original service lines were moved into recurring revenue, and it matters which two

Historical migration became Line C, evidence reconstruction, because it is sold against a duty rather than against a project brief. Connectors and integrations became a named meter inside Line F, because a customer on three banks and two processors pays for five connections whether or not anybody is doing project work that year. Both moves take revenue out of the services column and into a line that recurs, which is why services fall as a share of the total while the dollar figure holds.

12 What every one of them is missing

Five capabilities were tested across the whole set. The result is the same in every category, and it does not change depending on which of our lines is being compared.

The Canadian rule	Zero of twenty three carry SOR/2023-229. Drata publishes 33 frameworks and Vanta 23, between them covering New York, federal United States and Australian prudential rules, and no Canadian one.
A record that is provably unaltered	Two vendors use the word immutable. One describes no mechanism at all. The other means append only double entry bookkeeping, a property of the architecture rather than something an outside party can verify. Nobody sells a record an independent reviewer can prove has not been touched.
Both sides of the position	The evidence platforms hold controls and screenshots and never see money. The ledger products hold what is owed and carry no compliance duty. Four British products hold both, against another country's rules.
History that was never captured	All twenty three begin monitoring on the day they are connected, and none can produce a record of a day before that.
A page a regulator is sent to	The closest analogues are a customer facing page listing certificates held, and auditor read only access to control test results. Neither is a citable record of a safeguarding position on a stated day.

1 What this means for the price

- There is no incumbent to be measured against on any line.
- Every comparable in this document is either doing less than we do, or doing the same job under another country's rules.
- The buyer's real alternative is an adviser who will not quote until they have scoped.

2 What it does not mean

- It is not a moat. Adding a rule to a framework library is a week of work.
- It is a window, open because nobody has pointed at Canada yet.
- What closes it is signed Canadian customers, not a better argument.

13 Where every price came from

Every figure in this document was read on the publisher's own page on 16 or 17 August 2026. Each publisher below is a link that opens that page.

What was taken	Publisher, click to open	Class
The daily ledger duty and the review	Justice Laws, SOR/2023-229	Primary
Registration fee and the annual report	Bank of Canada	Primary
Safeguarding tier pricing, published in full	Guardexia	Primary
Entry pricing and contract term	Kani Payments , and Capterra	Primary
The coverage claim naming Canada	AutoRek	Primary
Published tiers, and the client asset note	Equali	Primary
Framework catalogues carrying no Canadian rule	Drata , and Vanta	Primary
Observed contracts by company size	Vendr on Drata , Vanta and Workiva	Secondary
Programme cost bands	BD Emerson , on AuditBoard	Secondary
What the archive actually holds	Global Relay , Smash and Mimecast	Primary
Published retention pricing	Microsoft Purview , Proofpoint and Iron Mountain	Primary
Metered pricing with no published rates	Modern Treasury , and Cable	Primary
Canadian advisers who publish no rate	Outlier Solutions , ComplyFactor and Renno and Company	Primary
Canadian programme and storage budgets	Equilex	Secondary
Compliance officer pay, Canada	AML Incubator	Secondary
Entry tier pricing	Sumsub , and ComplyAdvantage	Secondary
United States and pound sterling rates	Bank of Canada and sterling	Primary
Every figure about our own lines	4orm Finance master pro forma of 17 August 2026	Model

Legend. Primary means read on the publisher's own material. Secondary means a third party compilation of contracts actually signed, which records what buyers paid rather than what a vendor lists. Model means it comes from our own workbook and can be recalculated.